

Christ Session Exaltation

doc-christ-session-exaltation

Christology · Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide

directness direct

variants stable

Statement under examination

The risen Christ is exalted at the right hand of the Father, reigning and interceding for His people.

In plain language

The New Testament repeats a tight word cluster whenever it describes what the risen Jesus is doing now, and it all traces back to one Old Testament verse. In Psalm 110:1 the LORD tells David's Lord to sit at my right hand until I make your enemies a footstool. The Hebrew verb for sit there (shev, שׁוּב, a qal imperative, the simple active command form) is a command, second person, addressed by God to a second figure, so the grammar cannot mean God seating himself. The Greek translation (the Septuagint, LXX) reads 'sit at my right hand' (kathou ek dexiōn mou), and the New Testament quotes those exact words in Matthew 22:44, Mark 12:36, Luke 20:42, Acts 2:34, and Hebrews 1:13, every time using the seated-state verb 'be seated, sit' (kathēmai) with the phrase 'at the right hand' (ek dexiōn). Alongside the quotations, several writers make their own session statement (their own report that Christ has been enthroned-seated) using a second seating verb 'to sit down' (kathizō), in the aorist (a completed past action): Hebrews 1:3, Hebrews 8:1, Hebrews 10:12, and Hebrews 12:2 say 'he sat down' (ekathisen) at the right hand, and Ephesians 1:20 says the Father 'having seated him' (kathisas) there. The same verb is plain in Colossians 3:1, where Christ is 'seated' (kathēmenos), and Revelation 3:21, where he says 'I sat down' (ekathisa) with the Father on his throne. Hebrews 10:12 sets the seated Christ against the standing priests to show the one sacrifice is finished. Two verses add the present-tense verb 'to intercede' (entynchanō): Hebrews 7:25 says he always lives to intercede for those who come to God, and Romans 8:34 stacks four clauses, died, raised, at God's right hand, intercedes for us. The phrase 'at the right hand' is the Hebrew 'right hand' (yamin) idiom of supreme honor and authority, used 140 times across the Old Testament, so even readers who hear it as a literal place agree it marks the highest status. The exaltation verb 'highly exalted' (hyperypsoō) in Philippians 2:9 occurs only once in the whole Bible (a hapax), but its own clause, the name above every name, settles its meaning. Old Testament oracle, repeated session vocabulary across many writers, and a present-tense intercession verb all converge on the same conclusion, that the risen Christ is now exalted at the Father's right hand, reigning and interceding.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0113	אֲדֹן	adon	lord	
H3068	יְהוָה	yehovah	LORD	
H3225	יָמִין	yamin	right	140
H3427	יָשַׁב	yashav	to dwell	1,082
G0746	ἀρχή	archē	beginning	

G1188	δεξιός	dexios	right	54
G1342	δίκαιος	dikaios	just	
G1411	δύναμις	dunamis	power	
G1453	ἐγείρω	egeirō	to arise	
G1577	ἐκκλησία	ekklēsia	assembly	
G1793	ἐντυγχάνω	entynchanō	to call on	5
G1849	ἐξουσία	exousia	authority	103
G1860	ἐπαγγελία	epangelia	promise	
G2032	ἐπουράνιος	epouranios	heavenly	19
G2198	ζάω	zaō	to live	
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	
G2378	θυσία	thusia	sacrifice	
G2476	ἵστημι	histēmi	to stand	
G2512	καθαρισμός	katharismos	cleansing	
G2521	κάθηναι	kathēmai	to sit	89
G2523	καθίζω	kathizō	to seat	46
G2776	κεφαλή	kephalē	head	
G2963	κυριότης	kuriotēs	lordship	
G3172	μεγαλωσύνη	megalōsynē	majesty	3
G3686	ὄνομα	onoma	name	
G3875	παράκλητος	paraklētos	counsellor	5
G3962	πατήρ	patēr	father	
G5228	ὑπέρ	huper	above/for	
G5251	ὑπερυψώω	hyperypsoō	to exalt	1
G5286	ὑποπόδιον	hupopodion	footstool	
G5293	ὑποτάσσω	hupotassō	to subject	
G5312	ὑψώω	hypsoō	to lift up	20
G5483	χαρίζομαι	charizō	to give grace	
G5547	Χριστός	Christos	Christ	

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Two related seating verbs and a recurring location idiom (a fixed figurative phrase) carry this proposition across the canon. The New Testament citations of Psalm 110:1 (Matthew 22:44, Mark 12:36, Luke 20:42, Acts 2:34, Hebrews 1:13) keep the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) wording with 'be seated, sit' (kathēmai, G2521), in the present middle imperative form 'be seated' (Κάθου, an ongoing command directed at one person), plus 'at the right hand' (ek dexiōn, G1188) and a footstool clause. The declarative session statements (statements that simply report the seating as fact) use the aorist (a completed past action) of 'to sit down' (kathizō, G2523), either intransitive 'he sat down' (ekathisen, in Hebrews 1:3, Hebrews 8:1, Hebrews 10:12, Hebrews 12:2) or transitive

with the Father as subject 'having seated him' (kathisas, in Ephesians 1:20), both landing on the phrase 'at the right hand' (en dexia). The Hebrew of Psalm 110:1 forecloses ambiguity: 'sit' (shev, שֶׁב) is a qal imperative (the simple active command form of the Hebrew verb) addressed by 'the LORD' (YHWH, יְהוָה) to 'my Lord' (adon, אֲדֹנָי), set at YHWH's 'right hand' (yamin, יָמִין, H3225). The present-tense verb 'to intercede' (entynchanō, G1793) in Hebrews 7:25 and Romans 8:34 binds ongoing intercession to the session (Christ's enthroned seating). The pattern spans Psalter, Gospels, Acts, Paul, Hebrews, and 1 Peter, and holds across all surveyed variant readings.

Scripture

Ps.110.1 · **for** · genre: wisdom · figures: idiom

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0113 אֲדֹנָי, H3427 שֶׁב, H3225 יָמִין.

Force. Old Testament enthronement oracle (royal seating-on-throne pronouncement) and the source-text of the whole cluster. The Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible (OSHB) morphology confirms 'sit' (shev, שֶׁב, H3427) as a qal imperative second masculine singular (the simple active command form of the Hebrew verb, addressed to one male, tagged HVqv2ms), so 'the LORD' (YHWH, יְהוָה, H3068) commands 'David's Lord' (adon, אֲדֹנָי, H0113) to sit at his 'right hand' (li-yamini, לִי־יָמִין, H3225) until enemies are made a 'footstool' (hadom, הָדוֹם, H1916). The imperative (the command form) addressed by YHWH to a second party forecloses any reading in which YHWH himself is the one seated. The Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) renders it 'Sit at my right hand' (kathou ek dexiōn mou, κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου), the exact wording the New Testament citations carry over.

Matt.22.44 · **for** · genre: gospel · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθηναι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Jesus quotes Psalm 110:1 with the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) wording 'Sit at my right hand' (Kathou ek dexiōn mou, Κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου). The verb is 'be seated, sit' (kathēmai, G2521), in the present middle imperative form 'be seated' (Kathou, V-PNM-2S, an ongoing command addressed to one person), the seated-state verb (the verb that describes the ongoing posture of sitting), paired with 'at my right hand' (ek dexiōn mou) and the footstool clause. Jesus presses that David calls this figure Lord, making the right-hand session (enthroned seating) a claim about the Messiah's status above David.

Acts.2.34 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθηναι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Peter's Pentecost sermon quotes Psalm 110:1 word-for-word, 'Sit at my right hand' (Kathou ek dexiōn mou, Κάθου ἐκ δεξιῶν μου), again with 'be seated, sit' (kathēmai, G2521) and 'at the right hand' (ek dexiōn, G1188). Verse 33 has just said Christ was 'exalted' (hypsōtheis, ὑψωθείς, G5312, aorist passive participle, 'having been lifted up') to the right hand, so Luke binds the explicit Psalm 110 quotation to the narrated session (enthroned seating).

Heb.1.13 · **for** · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2521 κάθηναι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Hebrews quotes Psalm 110:1 with 'be seated, sit' (kathēmai, G2521), in the present middle imperative form 'be seated' (Kathou, V-PNM-2S, an ongoing command to one person), and 'at my right hand' (ek dexiōn mou) plus the 'footstool of the feet' (hypopodion tōn podōn, ὑποπόδιον τῶν ποδῶν, G5286). The rhetorical question asks to which of the angels God ever said this, reserving the right-hand session (enthroned seating) for the Son alone.

Heb.1.3 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G3172 μεγαλωσύνη, G2512 καθαρισμός

Force. Declarative session statement (a statement that simply reports the seating as fact). The Macula morphology reads 'he sat down' (ekathisen, ἐκάθισεν, G2523, V-AAI-3S, intransitive aorist 'he sat down', a completed past action with no direct object) 'at the right hand of the Majesty on high' (en dexia tēs Megalōsynēs en hypsēlois, ἐν δεξιᾷ τῆς Μεγαλωσύνης ἐν ὑψηλοῖς). The preceding aorist middle participle 'having made' (poiēsamenos, ποιησάμενος) of 'purification' (katharismos, G2512) frames the seating as the result of completed atonement. Here the Son is the subject who sits, the complement to Ephesians 1:20 where the Father seats him.

Heb.10.12 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G2378 θυσία

Force. 'Having offered one sacrifice for sins forever, he sat down at the right hand of God' (mian hyper hamartiōn prosenenkas thysian eis to diēnekes ekathisen en dexia tou Theou, μίαν ὑπὲρ ἁμαρτιῶν προσενέγκας θυσίαν εἰς τὸ διηνεκές ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ). The aorist (a completed past action) 'he sat down' (ekathisen, ἐκάθισεν, of kathizō, G2523) of the seated Christ stands in deliberate verbal contrast to the standing priests of verse 11, so the seated posture marks the finished sufficiency of the one sacrifice.

Heb.7.25 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1793 ἐντυγχάνω, G2198 ζάω, G5228 ὑπέρ

Force. 'Always living to intercede for them' (pantote zōn eis to entynchanein hyper autōn, πάντοτε ζῶν εἰς τὸ ἐντυγχάνειν ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν). The present participle 'living' (zōn, ζῶν, G2198) plus the articular infinitive of purpose (a 'the X-ing' verbal noun signaling purpose) 'for the interceding' (eis to entynchanein, εἰς τὸ ἐντυγχάνειν, of entynchano, G1793, present infinitive 'to intercede') make ongoing intercession the standing activity of the living, exalted Christ for those who draw near to God through him.

Rom.8.34 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G1188 δεξιός, G1793 ἐντυγχάνω, G5228 ὑπέρ

Force. Four clauses in sequence: 'died' (apothanōn, ἀποθανών), 'was raised' (egertheis, ἐγερθεῖς, of egeirō, G1453, aorist passive participle, 'having been raised', a completed past passive action), 'is at the right hand of God' (estin en dexia tou Theou, ἐστὶν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ, with dexios, G1188), and 'intercedes for us' (entynchanei hyper hēmōn, ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, of entynchano, G1793, present indicative, an ongoing simple statement of fact, V-PAI-3S). Resurrection, session (enthroned seating), and present intercession are bundled as the present ground for no condemnation.

Eph.1.20 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός, G2032 ἐπουράνιος

Force. 'Having raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places' (egeiras auton ek nekron kai kathisas en dexia autou en tois epouraniois, ἐγείρας αὐτὸν ἐκ νεκρῶν καὶ καθίσας ἐν δεξιᾷ αὐτοῦ ἐν τοῖς ἐπουράνιοις). The Macula morphology reads 'having seated' (kathisas, καθίσας, of kathizō, G2523) as a transitive aorist active participle (V-AAP-NSM, 'having seated him', a completed past action that takes a direct object), so here the Father is the agent who raises and seats the Son. The same verb that is intransitive (no direct object) in Hebrews 1:3 is causative (causing-someone-to-do) here, but both place Christ 'at the right hand' (en dexia, ἐν δεξιᾷ).

Eph.1.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0746 ἀρχή, G1849 ἐξουσία, G1411 δύναμις, G2963 κυριότης

Force. 'Far above every rule and authority and power and dominion' (hyperanō pasēs archēs kai exousias kai dynamēōs kai kyriotētos, ὑπεράνω πάσης ἀρχῆς καὶ ἐξουσίας καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ κυριότητος). A four-fold catalogue of cosmic powers, with the comprehensive 'every' (pasēs, πάσης) and the temporal pairing of this age and the age to come, brackets the right-hand session (enthroned seating) as supremacy over every rule.

Eph.1.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5293 ὑποτάσσω, G2776 κεφαλή, G1577 ἐκκλησία

Force. 'He subjected all things under his feet and gave him as head over all things to the church' (panta hypetaxen hypo tous podas autou kai auton edōken kephalēn hyper panta tē ekklēsia, πάντα ὑπέταξεν ὑπὸ τοὺς πόδας αὐτοῦ καὶ αὐτὸν ἔδωκεν κεφαλὴν ὑπὲρ πάντα τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ). The footstool image of all things under his feet reuses the Psalm 110:1 and Psalm 8:6 footstool motif and ties the cosmic reign to headship over the church.

Phil.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5251 ὑπερυψώω, G5483 χαρίζομαι, G3686 ὄνομα

Force. 'Therefore God also highly exalted him and graciously gave him the name above every name' (dio kai ho Theos auton hyperypsōsen kai echarisato autō to onoma to hyper pan onoma, διὸ καὶ ὁ Θεὸς αὐτὸν ὑπερύψωσεν καὶ ἐχαρίσατο αὐτῷ τὸ ὄνομα τὸ ὑπὲρ πᾶν ὄνομα). The verb 'highly exalted' (hyperypsōsen, ὑπερύψωσεν, of hyperypsoō, G5251) is a single-occurrence compound (a hapax, a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible), formed from 'over, above' (hyper, ὑπὲρ) plus 'to exalt' (hypsōō, ὑψώω), found nowhere else in the canon, so its sense cannot be triangulated from parallels. The immediate clause disambiguates it: God grants the name above every name, an unmistakable supreme-exaltation sense.

Acts.2.33 · for · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G5312 ὑψώω, G1188 δεξιός, G1860 ἐπαγγελία

Force. 'Therefore being exalted to the right hand of God' (tē dexia oun tou Theou hypsōtheis, τῇ δεξιᾷ οὖν τοῦ Θεοῦ ὑψωθεῖς). The aorist passive participle (a 'having been done' completed-action verbal adjective) 'having been exalted' (hypsōtheis, ὑψωθεῖς, of hypsoō, G5312) ties the exaltation to the right hand directly to the outpouring of the Spirit, and verse 34 supplies the Psalm 110:1 quotation as the proof.

Col.3.1 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G5547 Χριστός, G2521 κάθηναι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. 'Where Christ is, seated at the right hand of God' (hou ho Christos estin en dexia tou Theou kathēmenos, οὗ ὁ Χριστός ἐστιν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ Θεοῦ καθήμενος). The present participle 'seated' (kathēmenos, καθήμενος, of kathēmai, G2521, V-PNP-NSM, an ongoing 'being-seated' verbal adjective for a single male subject) describes the abiding seated state of Christ as the orientation point for the believer's life, the stative verb (a verb describing an ongoing state, not an action) matching the Psalm 110 citation verb rather than the aorist (a completed past action) of 'to sit down' (kathizō, καθίζω).

Heb.12.2 · for · genre: epistle · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G1188 δεξιός

Force. 'And has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God' (en dexia te tou thronou tou Theou kekathiken, ἐν δεξιᾷ τε τοῦ θρόνου τοῦ Θεοῦ κεκάθικεν). The perfect tense 'has sat down' (kekathiken, κεκάθικεν, of kathizō, G2523, perfect active, a completed action whose result still stands) reports the completed and abiding result of the seating at the right hand of God's throne, adding a third aspectual witness (perfect tense, a completed action whose result still stands) alongside the aorist (a completed past action) of Hebrews 1:3 and the present of Colossians 3:1.

1Pet.3.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1188 δεξιός, G5293 ὑποτάσσω, G1849 ἐξουσία

Force. 'Who is at the right hand of God, having gone into heaven, with angels and authorities and powers subjected to him' (hos estin en dexia Theou poreutheis eis ouranon, hypotagentōn autō angelōn kai exousiōn kai dynamēōn, ὅς ἐστιν ἐν δεξιᾷ Θεοῦ πορευθεὶς εἰς οὐρανόν, ὑποταγέντων αὐτῷ ἀγγέλων καὶ ἐξουσιῶν καὶ δυνάμεων). An independent Petrine attestation of the right-hand session (enthroned seating) with the same subjected-powers vocabulary as Ephesians 1:20-21, showing the formula is not confined to one writer.

Rev.3.21 · for · genre: apocalyptic

Key terms. G2523 καθίζω, G2362 θρόνος

Force. 'As I also overcame and sat down with my Father on his throne' (hōs kagō enikēsa kai ekathisa meta tou Patros mou en tō thronō autou, ὡς κἀγὼ ἐνίκησα καὶ ἐκάθισα μετὰ τοῦ Πατρὸς μου ἐν τῷ θρόνῳ αὐτοῦ). The aorist (a completed past action) 'I sat down' (ekathisa, ἐκάθισα, of kathizō, G2523) has Christ as speaker reporting that he sat down with the Father on his throne, making the session (enthroned seating) a shared-throne enthronement, not mere proximity.

1John.2.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G3962 πατήρ, G1342 δίκαιος

Force. 'We have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous' (paraklēton echomen pros ton patera, lēsoun Christon dikaiōn, παράκλητον ἔχομεν πρὸς τὸν πατέρα, Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν δίκαιον). The forensic advocacy noun 'advocate, helper' (paraklētos, παράκλητος, G3875) supplies a second lexeme (a second distinct vocabulary word) for the same heavenly office that 'to intercede' (entynchanō, ἐντυγχάνω) names with a verb, an advocate with the Father on the believer's behalf.

Acts.7.55 · complicates · genre: narrative · figures: idiom

Key terms. G2476 ἵστημι, G1188 δεξιός

Force. Stephen sees Jesus 'standing at the right hand of God' (hestōta ek dexiōn tou Theou, ἐστῶτα ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ). The perfect participle (a 'having-X-ed' verbal adjective whose result still stands) 'standing' (hestōta, ἐστῶτα, of histēmi, G2476) differs from the seating verbs, but the location phrase 'at the right hand of God' (ek dexiōn tou Theou, of dexios, G1188) is identical to every session text. The posture verb varies, the right-hand exaltation does not.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Ps.110.1	Heb.1.13	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Heb.1.3	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Eph.1.20	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Col.3.1	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Acts.2.34	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Matt.22.44	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Mark.12.36	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Luke.20.42	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	1Pet.3.22	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Phil.2.9	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	Heb.8.1	openbible	1
Ps.110.1	1Cor.15.25	openbible	1
Heb.1.3	Heb.4.14	tsk	1
Heb.7.25	Heb.9.24	tsk	1
Rom.8.34	Rom.8.27	tsk	1
Rom.8.34	Rom.4.25	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Acts.7.55 · addressed

Stephen sees Jesus 'standing' (hestōta, ἐστῶτα, of histēmi, G2476, perfect active participle, a 'having stood and still standing' verbal adjective) at the right hand, against the otherwise uniform seated posture. The Macula morphology confirms the location phrase 'at the right hand of God' (ek dexiōn tou Theou, ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ, of dexios, G1188) is word-for-word the session (enthroned-seating) location, so only the posture verb differs. The narrative depicts the Son rising in judicial witness for the dying martyr, a contextual exception that leaves the right-hand exaltation itself untouched. The verb 'be seated' (kathēmai, κάθημαι) or 'to sit down' (kathizō, καθίζω) never reverses anywhere else, so the standing is a single deliberate variation, not a competing pattern.

Mark.16.19 · addressed

'He sat down at the right hand of God' (ekathisen ek dexiōn tou Theou, ἐκάθισεν ἐκ δεξιῶν τοῦ Θεοῦ, of kathizō, G2523, and dexios, G1188) appears in the longer ending of Mark, which is text-critically disputed (debated as to whether it was original) and absent from Sinaiticus and Vaticanus (two major early manuscripts). The verdict does not rest on it, because the seating formula is independently and securely attested in Hebrews 1:3, Hebrews 8:1, Hebrews 10:12, Hebrews 12:2, Ephesians 1:20, Colossians 3:1, Acts 2:33-34, and 1 Peter 3:22.

Heb.7.25 · addressed

The intercession verb 'to intercede' (entynchanō, ἐντυγχάνω, G1793) occurs only five times in the canon, which alone would be thin, but two of those five (Hebrews 7:25, Romans 8:34) are exactly this Christ-interceding-for-his-people sense and the noun 'advocate, helper' (paraklētos, παράκλητος, G3875, 1 John 2:1) supplies a second independent lexeme (a second distinct vocabulary word) for the same office, so the low count is offset by a converging synonym rather than left as an unsupported hapax-like (one-occurrence-like) claim.

Concordance traversed

G2521, G2523, G1188, G1793, G5312, G5251, H3427, H3225, G3172, G3875, G2032, G1849, G1453, G2476, G5286, G2963

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

mark-longer-ending at Mark.16.19: impact none. The longer Markan ending is text-critically disputed (debated as to whether it was original), but the session formula (the seating phrase) it carries 'he sat down at the right hand' (ekathisen ek dexiōn, ἐκάθισεν ἐκ δεξιῶν) is redundant with the securely attested cluster in Hebrews, Paul, Acts, and 1 Peter, so dropping it does not move the verdict.

christos-iesous-word-order at Rom.8.34: impact none. Witnesses vary on whether the subject reads 'Christ' (Christos, Χριστὸς), 'Christ Jesus' (Christos Iēsous, Χριστὸς Ἰησοῦς), or adds 'the one having died' (ho apothanōn, ὁ ἀποθανών) word order, but none of these touch the 'at the right hand' (en dexia, ἐν δεξιᾷ) session clause or the 'he intercedes' (entynchaneī, ἐντυγχάνει) intercession clause, so the lexical verdict holds across all readings.

di-heautou-addition at Heb.1.3: impact none. The phrase 'through himself' (di heautou, δι' ἑαυτοῦ) before 'purification' (katharismos, καθαρισμὸν) is omitted by Papyrus 46 (p46) and Codex Vaticanus (B) but present in the Majority text. The seating clause 'he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty' (ekathisen en dexia tēs Megalōsynēs, ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τῆς Μεγαλωσύνης) is untouched by this variant.

All cited New Testament verses sit in books not yet fully published in the ECM apparatus (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants, the ingested window of which is 3 John 1:1 to 1:15 only). The Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF) New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (NTVMR) provides apparatus access but no Coherence-Based Genealogical Method (CBGM) stemma (manuscript family tree) for these passages. The variants surveyed do not move the verdict.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. redemptive-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology

covenant_theology: affirms · Reads Psalm 110 as the Davidic-covenant oracle (royal-promise pronouncement) fulfilled in the Son who sits as priest-king after the order of Melchizedek, with Hebrews 1:3 and Hebrews 7:25 binding session (enthroned seating), royal reign, and priestly intercession into one continuous office.

dispensationalism: affirms · Distinguishes a present heavenly session (enthroned seating in heaven now) from a future earthly Davidic reign, yet still affirms Christ's current enthronement at the Father's right hand and ongoing intercession (Hebrews 7:25, Romans 8:34) throughout the present age. The disagreement is over the timing of the earthly kingdom, not the present session.

new_covenant_theology: affirms · Treats the seated Christ of Hebrews 10:12 as the new-covenant high priest whose finished, once-for-all sacrifice ends the levitical pattern (the Old Testament priestly system descended from Levi), with present intercession sustaining the people of the new covenant.

right-hand idiom as spatial vs status: affirms · A minority reads 'at the right hand' (ek dexiōn, ἐκ δεξιῶν, and en dexia, ἐν δεξιᾷ) as primarily locating Christ in a place beside the Father, while the majority reads it as the Hebrew 'right hand' (yamin, יָמִין) idiom (fixed figurative phrase) of supreme honor and delegated authority. Both readings affirm the proposition: whether the phrase is taken spatially or as a status idiom, the text places the risen Christ at the position of supreme honor and rule. The 140 Old Testament occurrences of 'right hand' (yamin, יָמִין) favor the status sense, but the proposition holds under either reading, so this divergence is immaterial to the verdict.

All three major New Testament theological frameworks read the session-and-intercession cluster (the enthroned-seating-plus-praying-for-us word group) the same way. The only genuine divergence is over whether the right-hand phrase is heard as physical location or as a status idiom (a fixed figurative phrase signaling honor), and both hearings affirm the exaltation, so the divergence does not reach the verdict. The method is redemptive-historical because the verdict turns on the Psalm 110 oracle being carried forward and fulfilled across the canon.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem reports observable lexical content (right-hand enthronement plus intercession) and does not preload a contested ecclesial taxonomy (a disputed church-classification scheme). The glosses 'reigning' and 'interceding' are exegetical renderings (interpretive translations from the original languages) of the 'to sit down' (kathizō, καθίζω) and 'be seated' (kathēmai, κάθημαι) at-the-right-hand cluster and of 'to intercede' (entynchanō, ἐντυγχάνω) respectively, both directly attested. Verdict and confidence are unchanged from the prior file; the enrichment separates 'be seated' (kathēmai, κάθημαι, the Psalm 110 citation verb) from 'to sit down' (kathizō, καθίζω, the declarative session verb), records the genuine hapax (one-occurrence-only) status of 'highly exalted' (hyperypsoō, ὑπερυψώω) at Philippians 2:9, and adds the spatial-versus-status idiom divergence as a fairly stated minority lens.

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